

Georg von Westphalen



What Work Was For: A Field Report from Before the Timesheet

Uncle FrizzleBob's Kayfabizarro Komik Kult Kards for Bullshit Jobs

Vol. I



Stay fluffy!
* KayfaBIZARRO!

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Part I: Necessary Motion / Before we invented the timesheet, we just tried not to starve.

The Necessary Motion



POWER: Generates raw survival.

LORE: The bend worn into the earth over generations.

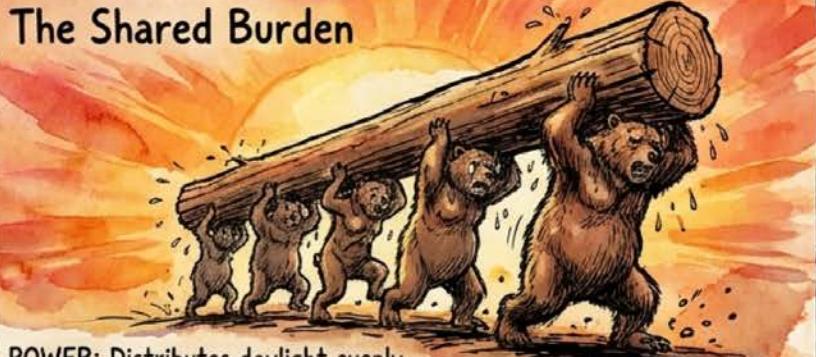
The First Division



POWER: Sorts the pack by utility.

LORE: The bad knee guards the young; the keen eye takes the high branches.

The Shared Burden



POWER: Distributes daylight evenly.

LORE: The day ended when there was enough.

The Pattern



POWER: Detaches repetition from appetite.

LORE: The moment "doing" became "duty".

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Part II: The Owners of the Day / Sound cuts the sun into slices.

The Not-Working



POWER: Creates the concept of laziness.

LORE: The small gap between bending out of hunger and bending out of habit.

The Monastery Bell



POWER: Slices the sun into eight prayers.

LORE: The day has owners, and they are calling.

The Factory Whistle



POWER: Transforms prayer into industrial shifts.

LORE: Time is now currency; it is spent, not passed.

The Long Day



POWER: Consumes all available existence.

LORE: Daylight is the only legitimate limit to availability.

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Part III: The Math of Meat / Breaking bodies into profitable fractions.

The Hour Saved



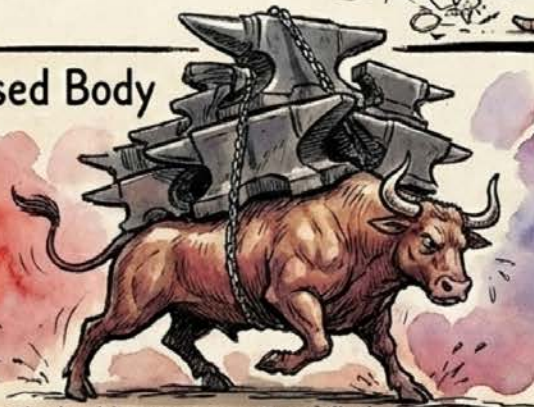
POWER: Reclaims exactly eight hours for "what we will."
LORE: A radical claim that some time belongs to the breather.

The Stopwatch



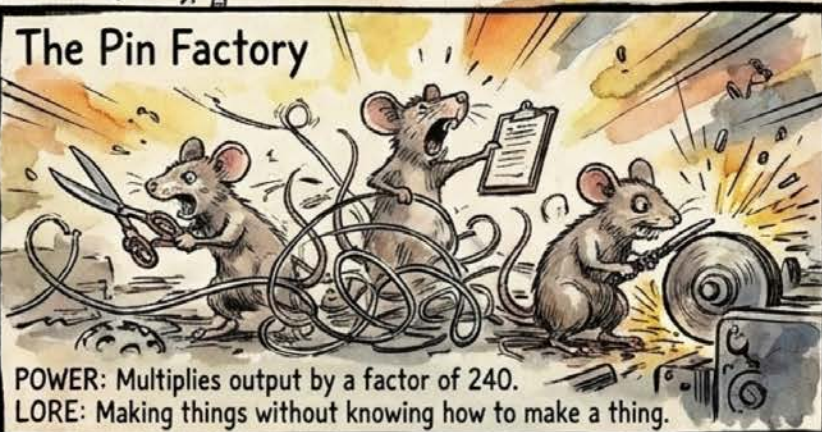
POWER: Fractures fluid movement into cold math.
LORE: The future belongs to the system; the past belonged to the beast.

The Optimised Body



POWER: Quadruples the load bearing capacity of flesh.
LORE: The first manual for treating the body as a gear.

The Pin Factory



POWER: Multiplies output by a factor of 240.
LORE: Making things without knowing how to make a thing.

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Part IV: The Wealth of Nations / You are poorer the more you produce.

The Division of Labour



POWER: Severs the maker from the whole.
LORE: Ten beasts make forty-eight thousand fragments.

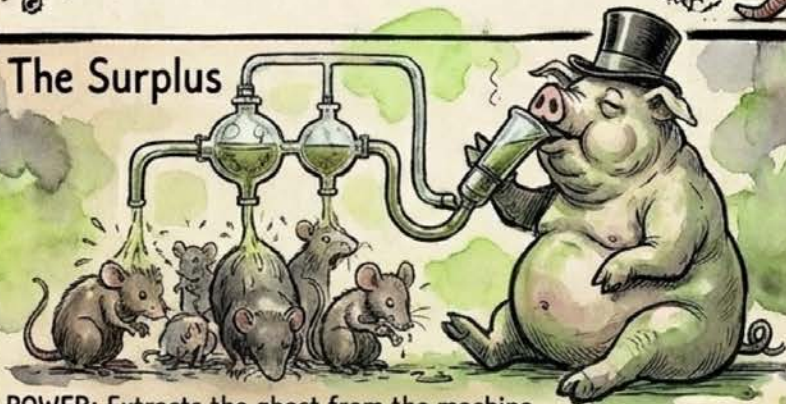
The Alienation



POWER: Enriches the system by impoverishing the soul.
LORE: The worker grows poorer the more wealth they produce.

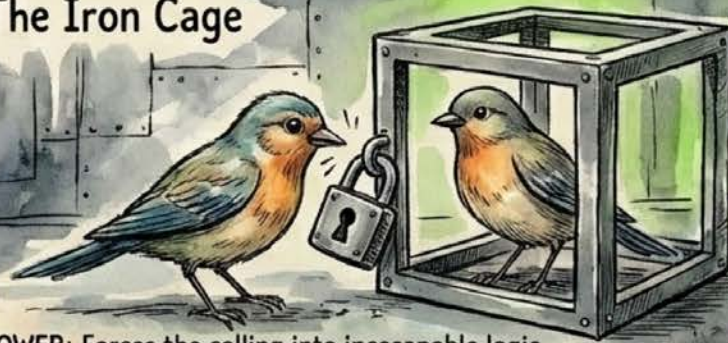
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The Surplus



POWER: Extracts the ghost from the machine.
LORE: The factory starves if the worker keeps what they make.

The Iron Cage



POWER: Forces the calling into inescapable logic.
LORE: No one can leave without ceasing to be modern.

The Commodity Labour



POWER: Puts life on a shelf with a price tag.
LORE: Land, coin, and sweat become goods.

The For-Sale Hour



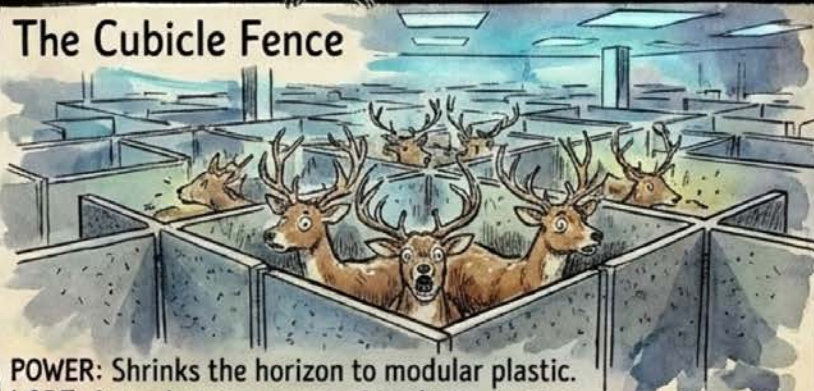
POWER: Trades the part of the self that fills the time.
LORE: The person becomes the meat inside the hour.

The Action Office



POWER: Liberates the thinker from the typing pool.
LORE: An invention designed to free you, destined to cage you.

The Cubicle Fence

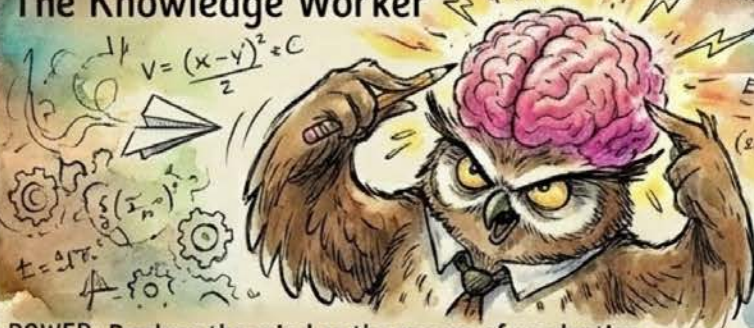


POWER: Shrinks the horizon to modular plastic.
LORE: A revolution mass-produced into a prison.

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Part VI: The Illusion of Dignity / You cannot whip a brain, you must memo it.

The Knowledge Worker



POWER: Deploys the mind as the means of production.
LORE: Cannot be coerced; must be persuaded, motivated, included.

The Memo



POWER: Replaces the physical whip with administrative paper.
LORE: The illusion of dignity, infinitely measurable.

The Meeting



POWER: Replaces the assembly belt with a conference table.
LORE: Where time goes to be collectively sacrificed.

The Cascade



POWER: Expands work to fill the allotted void.
LORE: It takes six weeks because six weeks were given.

What the
FLUFF?!

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Part VII: Measurement Psychosis / When the proxy becomes the god.

The Quarterly



POWER: Warps reality into three-month chunks.
LORE: The beast shapes itself to please the analyst.

The Goodhart Proxy



POWER: Destroys the underlying value of any measurement.
LORE: When a measure becomes a target, truth dies.

The Org Chart



POWER: Tells a comforting fiction about how power flows.
LORE: The real currents are sideways and in the shadows.

The Reorg



POWER: Shuffles the deck while the dealer cheats.
LORE: A periodic ritual to pretend the river changed course.

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Part VIII: The Annual Lie / The organisation pretends to know you.

The Performance Review



POWER: Forces mutual dishonesty once a year.
LORE: Most reviews are dishonest in both directions.

The Calibration Curve



POWER: Dooms a percentage of the pack before they begin.
LORE: The line was drawn before you entered the room.

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The Box-Ticker



POWER: Verifies the existence of a corporate lie.
LORE: Writing the report no one will ever read.

The Duct-Taper



POWER: Patches a glitch that should not exist.
LORE: Human glue for digital incompetence.

The Taskmaster



POWER: Manages the unmanageable for no reason.
LORE: Supervising those who already know what to do.

The Flunky



POWER: Magnifies the ego of the superior.
LORE: Existing solely to make someone else look important.

The Goon



POWER: Counters the enemy's identical minion.
LORE: The arms race of corporate lawyers and lobbyists.

The Ladder



POWER: Translates feudal advancement into cubicles.
LORE: The modern firm calls it seniority; the guild called it survival.

Part X: The Burnout Society / The exploiter and the exploited are the same beast.

The Title



POWER: Merges the core self with the corporate role.
LORE: When asked who you are, you answer what you do.

The Achievement-Subject



POWER: Exploits itself without external pressure.
LORE: The push is internal; the push is the air you breathe.

The Burned



POWER: Consumes the self from the inside out.
LORE: You cannot stop being the one who runs.

The Intolerable Burden



POWER: Turns the passage of time into physical agony.
LORE: Alienation felt in the bone, not the book.

The Mended Thing



POWER: Defeats the hermeneutics of suspicion.

LORE: The carburettor answers you in a way the spreadsheet never will.

The Skilled Hand

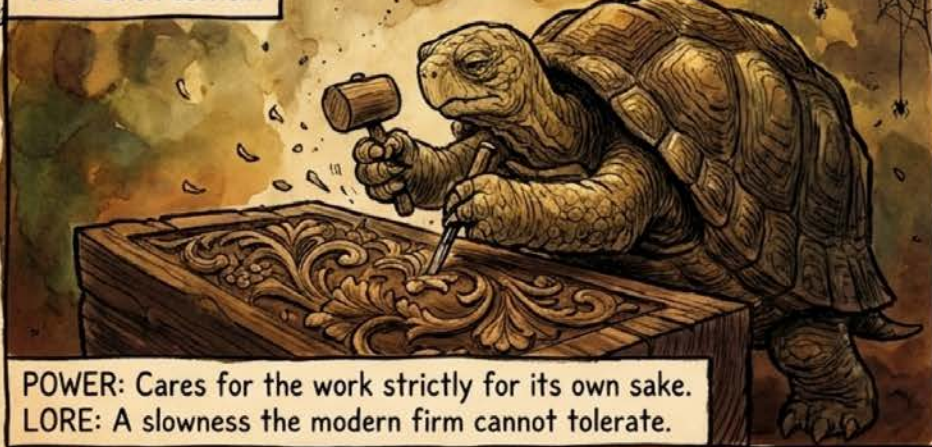


POWER: Remembers what the mind was trained to forget.

LORE: The body knows the whole object.

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The Craftsman



POWER: Cares for the work strictly for its own sake.

LORE: A slowness the modern firm cannot tolerate.

The Onboarded Apprentice



POWER: Replaces mastery with a slide deck.

LORE: We no longer apprentice; we are processed.

The Quiet Quitting



POWER: Delivers exactly what is paid for, no more.

LORE: The structural refusal to gift the surplus.

The Lying Flat



POWER: Denies the system its desires.

LORE: Only by doing nothing can you be the measure of all things.

The Side Project



POWER: Harbours the work that actually matters.

LORE: The sanctuary of the un-alienated soul.

The Fifteen-Hour Illusion



POWER: Promises a leisure that never arrives.

LORE: The productivity went somewhere, but it didn't come back to you.

The Always-On



POWER: Erases the boundary between dusk and dawn.
LORE: The Bed and the Desk have merged.

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The Notification



POWER: Invades the sanctuary of the mind at 11:47 PM.
LORE: The structural unit of the new, endless workday.



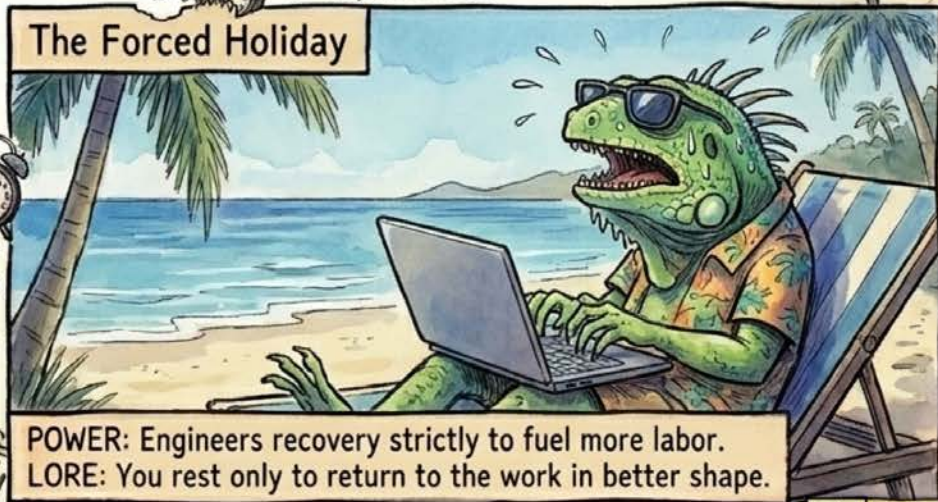
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The Pyjama Desk



POWER: Camouflages the office in domestic cloth.
LORE: A costume the office did not know it was getting.

The Forced Holiday



POWER: Engineers recovery strictly to fuel more labor.
LORE: You rest only to return to the work in better shape.

The Replacement



POWER: Waits patiently to inherit your function.
LORE: The replacement does not need a quarterly report.

The Obsolete Man



POWER: Manifests the shame of our own slowness.
LORE: Surpassed by our own products, smaller than ourselves.

The Idle Tool



POWER: Sits quietly where the worker used to stand.
LORE: The machine that no longer needs us.

The Real Leisure



POWER: Reclaims contemplation and festival.
LORE: The part of the day that has no purpose outside itself.



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